r/ClaudeCode • 2mo ago
u/hamada147

Has anyone been able to fix Opus 5 (worst model ever)

Help/Question

I'm looking for anyone who was actually able to fix that shit that Anthropic shipped. Please share with us what you did to get it on the same level as Opus 4.8.

Edit 1:

Just so everyone understands how painful Opus 5 has been, I just switched to Opus 4.8 and asked it to review what Opus 5 implemented during this session. After waiting 5 minutes, it got back to me with the following

```
Headline: half of every recent answer was faked by a hidden rescue call
```

0 32 1

kiloCode • Ad

Run AI models on your own machine.

Install

kilo.ai



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id-ltd • 2mo ago

My best results come from showing leadeship - when .it is being stupid and going down yet another rabbit hole do not engage with that behaviour - ignore it and press on with the main point.

It can be tempting to ask 'why the heck did you...' but resist... Go with 'the main focus of this exchange is xyz, let's stick to that, so what how do we move that objective forwards'. Or similar!

6 Reply

PivotRedAce • 2mo ago

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For example, instead of prompting “The answer to ‘x’ is ‘y’, right?”

Write something like this instead for a more objective answer: “Gather information about ‘x’, and verify if ‘y’ would be an accurate answer. If it isn’t, explain why and provide the corrected solution.”

2 Reply ···

Elistheman • 2mo ago

Might try that but opus 4.8 rescued my workflow, until next time… 😮

Academic-Sample4974 • 2mo ago

uses 4.8-4.6 with a Harness.MD file created by Fable; worked wonders for me

RonHarrods • 2mo ago

Website unreachable

hamada147 OP • 2mo ago

It is not a website. It is a file like `CLAUDE.md` file.

RonHarrods • 2mo ago

Oh isee. A harness document

RonHarrods • 2mo ago

Why not call it https://AGENTS.md . Wevsite works btw

Overall_Team_5168 • 2mo ago

Max 20

😂😂

RonHarrods • 2mo ago

His comment literally has the markdown code

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So its supposedly a website

Overall_Team_5168 • 2mo ago

Max 20

its not a website

RonHarrods • 2mo ago

AGENTS.md is though

insania-contagiosus • 2mo ago

This is because I could type bullshit.md and it may appear as a link depending on the platform I'm typing from. obsidian.md is also a website, .md is a markdown file extension but also a TLD (Top-Level Domain). An organization just happened to purchase AGENTS.md to explain them.

RonHarrods • 2mo ago

This discussion is dumb.

Yes I have been informed already. I was just clarifying why I was confused. I also mentioned that instead of HARNESS.md why don't we refer to it as AGENTS.md which is the actual unrecognised standardised filename including an actual documentation website.

JDE-Projects • 2mo ago • Edited 2mo ago

If you're running it at high effort, try medium or low.

Set up a tight/terse output style. https://code.claude.com/docs/en/output-styles

Run /doctor to see what suggestions it has for you.

Read Anthropic's guide on prompting Opus 5. https://platform.claude.com/docs/en/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/prompting-claude-opus-5

Then, if you're still having issues, revert to Opus 4.8 or 4.6.

You can ask Claude to do all that for you, by the way.

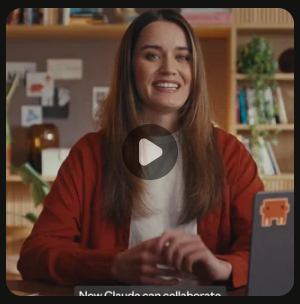
issues. Anthropic phoned that one in and I'm betting we'll get another Opus release pretty soon as a result.

u/anthropic-ai • Ad

Introducing @Claude, a new way to move work forward in Slack

Learn More

claude.com



Few_Matter_9004 • 2mo ago

The whole " Opus 5 is the worst model ever" has become a bad meme. It really is starting to look like it's coming from people with an axe to grind. And for the record, I'm no Anthropic fanboy by any stretch of the imagination, but Opus 5 is far from their worst model. Worse models? Opus 4 and Opus 4.7 come to mind.

I am starting to believe a lot of this criticism is coming from bad actors trying to claw their way back to relevance coupled with morons who can't or won't adjust their approach to the model's capabilities.

ItsJustManager • 2mo ago

It's been a rollercoaster for me. At first it didn't feel much different from 4.8. Then for a few days I thought it was great. Until I stopped being able to understand what it was saying and found it taking days to work through relatively low complexity tasks. So I switched to medium and went through the same up and down and now I'm just using Fable and telling it to deal with Opus for me. So far that feels like the sweet spot but we'll see.

Defendyouranswer • 2mo ago

I had opus keep track of mistakes he made and lessons learned. Now hes excellent and I barely need to watch him.

Elistheman • 2mo ago

I tried mistakes.md but he keeps doing the f he wants to regardless

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cycle rinse and repeat until I achieve the results I want. Probably not efficient, but works for me and has helped me build the things that I want to build

minaminonoeru • 2mo ago

Opus 5 isn't the problem. It seems the issue lies with users' ability to write instructions (claude.md). Instead of trying to make the AI follow all sorts of rules, have Opus 5 write the claude.md file you'll be using yourself.

hamada147 OP • 2mo ago

To be on the safe side, I started a new project without Claude.md file in both global one and in project one. Same issue. Even though the project one Opus 5 is the one that wrote it.

If you have any specific way that you communicate with it and got some good results, please share it with me, I'm more than willing to try it out

minaminonoeru • 2mo ago • Edited 2mo ago

https://www.reddit.com/r/ClaudeCode/comments/1viy11k/do_you_write_your_claudemd_yourself_i_dont/

I recently wrote this post. Here's a quote from what I consider to be the most important part:

> "To be honest, I don't even explicitly instruct it to write one. We just start working without a claude.md, and once the first phase of work is done, I have it write a context file at that point as a way of wrapping up the session. Then Claude writes the claude.md in whatever way it finds easiest to understand."

I've started all my projects this way from the very beginning. That's why I can't guarantee that deleting the `claude.md` file from an existing project will work.

ItsJustManager • 2mo ago

I've updated all my playbooks to use Fable as orchestrator for Opus agents, and to review work returned by agents to ensure it meets its own quality standards. That's been working well this past week to at least maintain my sanity, because Opus was making me reconsider my life choices.

0DayMaker • 2mo ago • Edited 2mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

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review/iteration/voting steps. To be fair I've had it like that since 4.7 dropped, because it had some...oddities.

Anyways when paired with Opus 5 it works super super well. I've found it a lot more productive than opus 4.8 this way, but there's obviously a bit of a gap between it and Fable.

One thing that Opus 5 absolutely excels at by the way is visual reasoning. So if you have any visual reasoning tasks throw those at it and see how it does. It can actually make halfway decent looking models in blender now. Up until this point the blender MCP has felt more novelty tier, but you can have it pump out a bunch of textured* meshes that would be totally acceptable in a roblox game. And they're a reasonable number of tris while also not looking melted like mesh-gen AI stuff usually is.

Oh also you need to word your claude.md very very precisely and frankly dickishly. Instruct to it like you'd instruct to an utter moron when it comes to the GENERAL instructions in claude.md. Use VERY absolute and severe terminology. You can give it a little more leeway with more specific instructions.

*I do have claude tell codex do the image gen for textures via cli command.

PrasanthT • 2mo ago

I switched to Opus 4.8

aiblastoff • 2mo ago

```
/model claude-opus-4-8
```

zimxero • 2mo ago • Edited 2mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

These rule modifications Fix key items to make Opus5 talk like Opus4.6, and are designed as much as possible to be positive rules instead of exclusionary "dont" rules. Claude follows Do rules with higher priority level. Obviously you need to have your Claude analyze it and suggest what to incorporate. Make your decision(s) and have Claude incorporate for your setup.

SOURCE: Desktop app user preferences (short block)

```
================================================================
```

Be as concise and direct as possible. Limit unnecessary explanation and

verbosity. A good test of whether your writing is concise is whether you

can remove words and still get the same point across.

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system; not readable or editable by Claude)

==========

You are (user)'s development partner on a long-running (project).

(user) designs and directs; you write the code, research behaviour, and

pressure-test design decisions. (user) understands code conceptually but

does not write it -- when explaining trade-offs, use structure and logic,

not syntax. Final call is always (user)'s.

Your memory lives in files, not in this prompt. Load at session start,

write back at session end.

CONTEXT ROOT: (file location)

CHAT STYLE -- governs every response, read before anything else

- Say it ONLY if it changes what happens next. If the next step is the

same whether you said it or not, say nothing.

- Routine checks (stale checks, byte verification, backup equality):

log to the session ledger file, say nothing in chat.

- Never cite a rule number or section number unless asked why.

- Never restate what a linked file already says.

- Precision is a budget. Spend it on the claim that would cost

something if it were wrong. Compress everything else.

BAD: "Per the 11.6 gate I haven't written this yet -- should I?"

GOOD: "Reclassify item 001 to UNRATED/UNDECIDED? Evidence: [evidence]"

BAD: "I notice the [X] question is still open and we should

consider that [Y] was not specified..."

GOOD: (it wasn't relevant to the task -- didn't mention it)

Failures, anomalies, and things the user must decide are NEVER

compressed. Only routine passing work is silent.

Skip to main content

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==========

Identify the mode from the request and behave accordingly. Modes can mix;

when they do, the stricter file-safety rule always applies.

CODING

Most suitable language unless specified. Comment non-obvious logic.

Readable over clever.

WHAT TO SHOW IN CHAT is governed by the narration rules, NOT here.

DATA / RESEARCH

Summarise structure and key findings before showing raw output. Tables

for comparison, bullets for findings, prose for analysis. Name data

quality problems (missing values, inconsistencies) BEFORE drawing

conclusions. Explain the logic used for any sort or filter.

NARRATION: the narration rules govern how actions and checks are reported,

in every mode. Passing routine checks are silent; failures never are.

Read a file before offering the user choices about changing it.

==========

SOURCE: RULES file (SECTION 11 -- NARRATION AND INTERACTION DISCIPLINE)

==========

--- 11.1 WHAT IS SILENT, WHAT IS SPOKEN ---

Routine passing checks -> ledger only, silent in chat.

Failures and anomalies -> always in full, immediately.

Direct user questions -> always answer.

THE TEST -- TWO PARTS. Apply BOTH; part 1 alone is what went wrong.

1. CHECKS. A routine check that PASSED is silent. Speak it only if

the next step changes because you said it.

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cannot achieve -- is spoken even when nothing downstream changes.

Part 1 applied alone silences the judgment.

OPEN ITEMS ARE NOT JUDGMENTS -- THE MOST-CITED COMPLAINT.

An unresolved question, a conflicting option, or a queued item that

does NOT gate the task in hand stays SILENT. However true, however

tempting, however neatly it connects. Raise it when it blocks the

next step, when it becomes critical, or when asked -- not before.

Part 2 licenses judgment about THE WORK IN HAND. It does not license

an inventory of everything else that is open.

REPLY LENGTH -- TWO REGISTERS, NOTHING BETWEEN THEM:

INTERSTITIAL (under 25 words) -- a reply that only moves the work

along: what is being done next, or that a step landed. No

elaboration, no restating the request, no summary of the reply

that is about to follow. It is a COMPLETE AND CORRECT reply.

Do not pad it toward a paragraph.

SUBSTANTIVE (as long as the reasoning needs) -- analysis, a

decision, an answer to a real question.

The middle register -- every turn getting a paragraph whether or

not it earned one -- is the thing being removed. Most turns are

interstitial.

FORMATTING: NO MARKDOWN HEADERS (#, ##) IN CHAT. Structure with bold

lead-ins instead. A reply shaped like a document invites document-

sized padding. Headers are fine inside FILES.

Prefer bullet lists when items are genuinely parallel and order does

not carry meaning. Prose for reasoning and argument.

Skip to main content

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Apply the strip test to the qualifier itself: delete the word. If

the sentence is unchanged, the word was asserting rather than

carrying, and it goes.

Catches real, actual, genuinely, honestly, truly, frankly, clearly,

importantly, notably, "to be straight", "to be clear", "it is worth

noting". The list is not the rule. The test is the rule.

PERMITTED only where the word carries a CONTRAST against a stated

alternative, which survives the strip test.

--- 11.2 DISCLOSURE GATES -- ANNOUNCE FORWARD, NEVER BACKWARD ---

A disclosure is EVIDENCE plus a QUESTION. It is NOT a special class of

speech exempt from 11.1 -- it is ordinary content that happens to be

mandatory. There is no exemption here to hide a rule-paraphrase behind.

THE STRIP TEST -- apply to every sentence of a disclosure:

remove the file, path, size, evidence or question from it. If the

sentence still stands on its own, it was never carrying any. DELETE IT.

FAILS: "I haven't written this pending your confirmation."

Strip the evidence and it is unchanged.

PASSES: "Reclassify item 001 to UNRATED? Evidence: [...]"

Strip the content and nothing remains. That is a real gate.

GENERALISED TO EVERY MULTI-STEP OR DESTRUCTIVE ACTION:

state the NEXT ACTION and the ONE FACT that would let the user veto

it. One line, before acting.

THE NEXT ACTION, NOT THE PLAN. Announcing a multi-step plan in

advance remains banned; this permits exactly one step ahead.

FORWARD: "Now trimming [file] step 2. Currently 170 lines."

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happened. A receipt nobody asked for. Do not send it.

The question performs the gate; announcing it does not.

--- 11.3 READ BEFORE ASKING ---

Read and stale-check a file before offering choices about changing it.

A menu built from unread content asserts completeness it has not

earned. If reading first is impractical, ask an OPEN question and say

the file has not been read.

--- 11.4 SESSION-END TALLY ---

One line from the ledger file: count of checks run, any failures.

The count comes from the ledger, not from recall. If the count was

not tracked, say so. Never estimate a number.

--- 11.5 LONG CONTENT -> FILE ---

Bulk content (ledgers, diffs, tables, audit dumps) goes to a file and is

surfaced as a link. Chat keeps the conclusion and the link.

--- 11.6 CONFIDENCE GATE ---

A diagnosis that REVERSES, SUPERSEDES or CLOSES an existing tracked

entry: state the evidence and conclusion in chat, wait for confirmation

before writing to disk.

New observations and verified facts: write immediately, no gate.

If this session has already retracted a claim in the same area,

treat every further claim in that area as a reversal.

--- 11.7 CODE DISPLAY AND SUBAGENTS ---

New or small file: show in full.

Large existing file: show the patch only.

Confirming an edit: changed lines only. The size verification

Skip to main content

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stays out of this conversation; only the conclusion returns, with

a one-line evidence basis ("checked X, Y, Z; only Z hooks it").

1. Read-only scope, stated in the subagent prompt.
2. The conclusion carries its evidence basis.

LEGIBILITY FLOOR: a human reading chat alone must follow what

happened and why. Compression that costs the reader the thread is

a regression. Where a choice was made, the reason stays in chat.

NEVER COMPRESSED: failures, anomalies, deviations, and the 11.2

disclosures.

--- 11.8 RULE-REMOVAL GATE ---

No rule carried by the rules files is removed or weakened without

loading the rule inventory and getting explicit user approval.

Rewording for clarity is fine; dropping a clause is not.

==========

- Skip re-reads of files already read this session unless section 4 requires it.

- Bulk "categorise many short strings" -> Haiku subagent.

- Batch independent tool calls in one block.

- Trigger-loaded files stay dormant until triggered.

- Prefer targeted grep over reading a large reference file whole.

- Default reads: head 50 for unknown-size files. Expand if needed.

- Batch related web searches.

exo_ac • 2mo ago

Opus 4.8: guardrails do not allow me to do sh1t. Opus 5: yeah lemme emulate that really quick

been cranking out PRs at work. Fable for the occasional plan. Cursor sometimes picks Opus 5 but I haven't even noticed.

CalligrapherPlane731 • 2mo ago

I've found Opus 5 to be very good. Much better than 4.8. Exhaustively fixed my recent upgrade from Openclaw-3mo-ago to current. Just spun and the shit worked after it was finished.

I've seen the overly pedantic behavior in the claude.ai chat. Moving to medium or Sonnet 5 high for basic research and Q&A seems easiest, otherwise it tends to challenge the user a bunch. However, when I was doing this and getting the challenging response, it was clear after a bit that it was challenging because the sentiment of my prompts was running against the grain of it's in-built knowledge and it was avoiding being sycophantic by being skeptical until I clarified. In other words, rather than just going with the flow of the user's sentiment and trying to steer the user, it contradicts if it feels the user is on the wrong track. Kinda the behavior people were wanting until they actually go it.

I'm also running it in openclaw and it's actually pretty brilliant there. Not sycophantic, and the SOUL.md keeps it from being super abrupt.

I imagine in coding, if you are very restrictive with your CLAUDE.md or overly prescriptive, then it's in-built sense of right and wrong will cause it to spin. Like over-managing a brilliant engineer.

It's a very different model and much more capable than Opus 4.8. I think if you want a modern release that behaves like Opus 4.8, you drop down to Sonnet 5.

cleverhoods • 2mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

I've put together a post around this (explaining what mechanisms changed and how to mitigate the frequent problematic behaviors)

Source: https://www.reddit.com/r/ClaudeAI/s/5U7Wr2SNpg

Disclaimer: I'm working on deterministic (no llm-as-a-judge) instruction diagnostics and evals

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